

Emily Koscielniak

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EDUCATION

New Jersey Institute of Technology (NJIT) | Newark, NJ Expected May 2027
Bachelor of Science in Human-Computer Interaction, Minor in Data Analytics | GPA: 3.54
BS/MS Information Systems

PROJECTS

1st Place Winner | NJIT SIGCHI Design Jam: funnymoney | Newark, NJ March 2026

- Spearheaded the end-to-end UX design of a financial wellness mobile application during an intensive 10-hour sprint, securing 1st place among competing teams
- Executed rapid user research with 42 participants, uncovering that 81% of young adults lack structured budgeting rules, which directly correlates to increased “adulting” anxiety and burnout
- Translated research insights into a high-fidelity Figma prototype featuring a "Fun Money" tracking gauge, automated savings progress bars, and a budget-synced activity finder
- Iterated on design requirements based on paper prototype user testing, resolving navigation friction to ensure an intuitive and accessible dashboard experience

1st Place Winner | Hack Van Houten: Wayfinding Application | Newark, NJ September 2025 – December 2025

- Executed a mixed-methods study with 45 participants to address navigation difficulty for patrons, identifying a 95.6% user demand to digital tools
- Validated usability disparities via independent-samples t-tests, revealing that infrequent visitors report significantly higher “lostness” scores
- Architected a QR-based framework providing turn-by-turn instructions via location-specific navigation codes and photographic references to reduce cognitive load
- Proposed an iBeacon BLE implementation roadmap for 2-meter indoor positioning accuracy (\$20k-\$60k budget) and presented the concept to library stakeholders

Mixed-Methods Study: *Laptop Stickers as Self-Expression* | Newark, NJ Spring 2025

- Conducted semi-structured interviews and visual ethnography with 16 participants to evaluate media consumption and digital identity
- Applied multi-cycle qualitative coding (In Vivo, Versus, Values) to identify themes regarding student self-expression and community belonging
- Synthesized research findings through affinity diagrams and thematic models to create a user experience research report and empathy maps

SKILLS

UX & Product Design: User Research, Information Architecture, User Flows, Wireframing, Prototyping, Responsive Design, Design Systems

Front-End & Technical: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Git/GitHub, Python, Java, C#, Docker

Data-Informed Design: SQL, Excel (Pivot Tables, Solver), Basic Data Visualization, Basic Data Visualization

Research & Professional Development: CITI RCR Certified (Responsible Conduct of Research)